BALL WITHOUT BOUNDARIES

THE SPORTS MONEY DNA · 4 MINUTES

HOW DOES YOUR FAMILY REALLY PAY FOR THE GAME?

Every report says youth sports costs keep climbing, and that a lot of families "go into debt." But nobody has asked **how**. Credit cards? Home equity? A second job? Grandma? We're finding out, so we can help sports families keep their kids playing **without wrecking everything else.**

+46%	$40B+	?
rise in what families spend on a child's main sport since 2019	spent by parents on youth sports every year	how families actually pay for it. Until now.

✓ Anonymous if you want ✓ Never sold, ever ✓ Shared only as group totals

How it works: Part A is 12 quick questions. Part B, the Deep Dive, is optional. Check the boxes, then find your family's **Sports Money DNA** type on the last page.

Stats: Aspen Institute Project Play, 2024 parent survey.

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CHOOSE ONE

How many of your kids play organized sports right now?

- ◯ 1
- ◯ 2
- ◯ 3
- ◯ 4+

2

CHOOSE ONE

What level is your most competitive athlete playing at?

- ◯ Rec / community
- ◯ Club / travel
- ◯ Multiple levels
- ◯ School team
- ◯ Elite / national / showcase

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CHOOSE ONE

Roughly how much does your family spend on youth sports per year, all-in? (All kids: fees, travel, hotels, gear, lessons, food on the road.)

- ◯ Under $1,000
- ◯ $2,500 – $5,000
- ◯ $10,000 – $20,000
- ◯ Honestly, I don't know
- ◯ $1,000 – $2,500
- ◯ $5,000 – $10,000
- ◯ $20,000+

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CHOOSE ONE

Which is the biggest single cost?

- ◯ Club or team fees
- ◯ Private lessons or training
- ◯ Equipment & uniforms
- ◯ Food on the road
- ◯ Travel & hotels
- ◯ Camps & clinics
- ◯ Tournament & showcase fees



THE KEY QUESTION · CHECK ALL THAT APPLY

How do you pay for it?

- [ ] Out of the regular paycheck (month to month)
- [ ] Savings we set aside specifically for sports
- [ ] General savings or emergency fund
- [ ] Credit card, paid off in full each month
- [ ] Credit card, carrying a balance
- [ ] Buy now, pay later (Klarna, Afterpay, Affirm...)
- [ ] The club's or program's payment plan
- [ ] Home equity line (HELOC) or home equity loan
- [ ] Cash-out refinance on our home
- [ ] Personal loan
- [ ] Borrowing from or withdrawing from a 401(k) or retirement account
- [ ] Money from grandparents or family
- [ ] Second job, overtime or a side hustle
- [ ] Fundraising, sponsorships or scholarships
- [ ] Selling things
- [ ] Something else: _____



Of everything you checked above, which ONE pays for the most?

_____



CHOOSE ONE

How much of your family's debt right now is because of youth sports?

- ◯ None
- ◯ Less than $1,000
- ◯ $1,000 – $5,000
- ◯ $5,000 – $15,000
- ◯ $15,000 – $30,000
- ◯ $30,000+
- ◯ Not sure



CHECK ALL THAT APPLY

To pay for sports, have you cut back on any of these?

- [ ] Retirement contributions
- [ ] College savings (529, etc.)
- [ ] Emergency savings
- [ ] Family vacations
- [ ] Home repairs
- [ ] Our own health or medical care
- [ ] Paying down other debt
- [ ] None of these

9 How stressful is paying for sports for your family?

1	2	3	4	5
No stress	Fine	It's tight	Hard	Keeps me up at night

10 Be honest: would you ever pull your child out of a sport because of money?

CHOOSE ONE

- ◯ No, we'll find a way
- ◯ Only if we truly had no choice
- ◯ We've considered it
- ◯ We've already had to

11 Do you and your partner ever disagree about sports spending?

CHOOSE ONE

- ◯ Never
- ◯ Sometimes
- ◯ Often
- ◯ It's a big source of tension
- ◯ Not applicable

12 If someone could help with ONE thing, what would it be?

CHOOSE ONE

- ◯ Lowering the cost of sports
- ◯ Paying off the debt it created
- ◯ Planning ahead for next season
- ◯ Getting on the same page with my partner
- ◯ Finding scholarships & sponsorships
- ◯ Protecting retirement & college savings

PART B - THE DEEP DIVE

Optional, about 5 more minutes. This is the data that helps us crack the code for every sports family.



CHOOSE ONE

Household income range (optional)

- ◯ Under $50K
- ◯ $50K – $75K
- ◯ $75K – $100K
- ◯ $100K – $150K
- ◯ $150K – $250K
- ◯ $250K+
- ◯ Prefer not to say



What's your child's main sport, and at what age did spending really take off?



CHOOSE ONE

If you used home equity, a refinance, a personal loan or retirement money, roughly how much went to sports?

- ◯ Didn't use these
- ◯ Under $5K
- ◯ $5K – $15K
- ◯ $15K – $30K
- ◯ $30K – $50K
- ◯ $50K+



CHOOSE ONE

Do you know the interest rate on the debt you use for sports?

- ◯ Yes, exactly
- ◯ Roughly
- ◯ No idea
- ◯ No debt



CHOOSE ONE

At your current pace, how long until your sports-related debt is paid off?

- ◯ Paid off monthly
- ◯ Under 6 months
- ◯ 6 – 12 months
- ◯ 1 – 3 years
- ◯ 3+ years
- ◯ Never at this rate

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CHOOSE ONE

Do you plan ahead for the season, or handle costs as they come?

- ◯ We plan the whole year
- ◯ We plan somewhat
- ◯ We handle it as it comes
- ◯ Bills surprise us every season

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CHOOSE ONE

What's driving the spending most?

- ◯ My child's love of the game
- ◯ College scholarship hopes
- ◯ Keeping up with the team
- ◯ Coach or club pressure
- ◯ Development & training needs
- ◯ Pro aspirations

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CHOOSE ONE

Do you believe the spending will "pay back" (scholarship, pro, etc.)?

- ◯ Yes, definitely
- ◯ Maybe
- ◯ Probably not, and that's OK
- ◯ I don't think about it that way

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In one sentence: what do you wish you'd known about the cost before you started?

_____

_____

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Want a founding seat or a 15-minute follow-up? (optional)

First name _____ Email _____

- ☐ 🏆 Tell me about becoming a Founding Member
- ☐ 📞 Open to a 15-minute follow-up call

FIND YOUR SPORTS MONEY DNA

Look at your answer to Question 6 (what pays for the most). That's your type.



THE PLANNER

Pays by: Pays from savings set aside for sports.

Next play: Sharpen the edges: travel hacks, team-buy gear, multi-season plan.



THE CASH-FLOW GRINDER

Pays by: Pays month to month from the paycheck.

Next play: Build a Season Fund. That's your first ONE BILL.



THE CARD SWIPER

Pays by: Uses a card, pays it off in full.

Next play: Set a season cap; point rewards at team travel.



THE BALANCE CARRIER

Pays by: Carries a card balance, BNPL or payment plans.

Next play: Your ONE bill is the card: payoff plan and a rate you know.



THE EQUITY TAPPER

Pays by: HELOC, cash-out refi or personal loan.

Next play: Know what the borrowing costs; plan so the house isn't funding next season.



THE FUTURE BORROWER

Pays by: 401(k) money or cut retirement contributions.

Next play: Protect retirement first; then scholarships and a funding plan.



THE VILLAGE-FUNDED

Pays by: Grandparents, side hustles, fundraising.

Next play: Make it sustainable for when the help changes.

THANK YOU FOR PLAYING.

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